



WandaVision in the 50s

Elizabeth Olsen reveals the Scarlet Witch and Vision TV series on Disney+ will be set in the 50s. <https://digit.in/may19-47>



Alien tabletop RPG

Free League Publishing, 20th Century Fox to create original tabletop RPG set in the world of Alien. <https://digit.in/may19-48>

then adds on, “Note: The drive reassignment is not limited to removable drives. Internal hard drives can also be affected.”

I pity the people who found out about this bug the hard way. Though in fairness, Microsoft has designed the update to just not work if there's any external drives attached to the PC at the time of updating. You get an error that tells you, “This PC cannot be upgraded to Windows 10”.

April was also a big month for entertainment. Marvel's massive conclusion to the latest Avengers predicament (Thanos killing half of all life) released the day after I wrote this piece, but those who were OK with watching a horrible cam-quality print of the movie could do so one whole day before the movie even released in the US. That was three whole days before the movie release in India, so you can just imagine how irritated folks at Disney were. I was even more irritated, but I'll get to why in a bit.

Another big release was Game of Thrones, which faithful fans have been waiting patiently for. The first episode was ‘leaked’ early to customers of DirectTV Now, a US-based service. Turns out it was just a glitch, and lucky customers got to watch it 4 hours in advance. Still; not a big deal because they would have got to watch it legally anyway. However, episode 2 was not so lucky, and leaked on torrent sites hours before the episode was scheduled to be aired.

Now don't get me wrong, I'm the last one to side for rich corporations and wag my hypocritical finger at all you ‘filthy pirates’. However, all these leaks do irritate me a lot. The web and social media clickbaits are so tempting these days that one cannot control the urge to click to find out more. These days, it would seem that in order to truly enjoy the experience of the plot reveal, one needs to become a hermit living in the Himalayas, without any cell phone access, and then come down off the mountain just in time to watch the series or movie that one is addicted to at the moment.

Leaks bring out the worst of humanity, the dregs of society, the scourge of the human race, and all-round rotten scoundrels... those idiots who take pleasure in posting spoilers! Can there ever be a worse example of a human being?

Can't people just be good pirates and watch their ill-gotten entertainment in silence? Do they have to then go online and ruin it for the rest of the world? How pathetic a person is someone if they gain a sense of importance by being universally hated? Usually I had a sensible timeframe in which to worry about encountering spoilers, and although still hard, it was at least doable. With leaks however, it's almost impossible to know when and where some idiot will spoil something for you. And as much as I'd want to disconnect from the internet, I can't because of work.

April, also brought with it the most ironical of all events. Ever.

Once upon a time there was a country that had no freedom of expression, or even freedom in general. It was well known the world over for committing human-right's violations, and widely criticised. Of course it was a powerful country, so not much could be done about all of this, given that forcing anything would start off WWII. So insular was this country, that it banned many foreign internet companies from conducting business, and almost had its own version of the internet. Copyright laws were flouted openly, and there was no respect at all for international law within its borders. That country, is of course, China.

A company from China called Bytedance started an app called TikTok that is very popular all over the world, and extremely so in India. Despite all of the political problems between the two countries, India has not stooped to the level of China and banned its products, because of course, we have a legal system that we actually follow. So when a court ordered that the app be removed from the App and Play stores for containing inappropriate content for children

(the majority of the app's users), it was really ironic to see the company cry foul, when they certainly wouldn't have been able to do so in China. Even more ironic was when they appealed in the court and got the decision overturned, something no Indian company (or global company for that matter) can ever hope to achieve in China.

Google is trying to get into China, of course, and that entails toeing China's line of suppressing results it doesn't like or approve of. Net neutrality be damned if there's business to be done. This isn't new, of course, as news of the so-called ‘Project-Dragonfly’ emerged in 2018. Then there was the walkout that was organised by women working inside Google, who were fed up with the sexual harassment and lack of consequences for perpetrators. Twenty thousand Google employees walked out of their office at 11:10 am all across the world in protest, and it started with Google's Japanese offices and ended with their American offices. It was sparked by a New York Times article that wrote about how male employees of Google who were accused of sexual harassment were given millions of dollars in exit packages, while the harassment itself was brushed under the carpet.

All this happened in 2018, but in April 2019 fresh controversy was stirred by the organisers of the walkout, as they reported in emails to co-workers that they were being punished by the company. The alleged punishment includes demotion and reassignment, and also a generally hostile work environment. It was the co-workers who shared the emails with Wired, which they published last month. Google has denied the allegations, but honestly, with flawed humans being involved, there's bound to be some resentment displayed towards someone perceived as a ‘troublemaker’. I just hate that even in 2019, in a progressive company like Google, men and women still can't just work together as equals!

And with that I think I've met my word count requirement... 